

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Thank you so much for your help!



Learning Outcome

Describe complicated or unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about technology and subjects of study.
- I can organize points in an argument.
- I can express possibility and certainty.

Ask your partner:

- Who have you received help from someone? How did they help you?
- How did you thank that person?





Let's Explore!

Donna Patrick expresses her **deepest gratitude*** to Dr. Richardson.

* We use the expression "*deepest gratitude*" to thank someone for going beyond what is usual.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Dear Dr. Richardson,

I am writing to express my deepest gratitude for what you have done for our son, Brad.

When Brad lost his leg in that horrific car accident last year, he was devastated. In fact, he became very depressed and withdrawn. Of course, we worried that this would be irrevocable. After all, Brad had always been an athlete and loved sports. So, he was certain that his life, as he knew it, would be over.

Then, your office contacted him and gave him hope. They told him about the incredible advances in prosthetic limbs. They said he could be fitted with a robotic prosthesis and that could be controlled with his mind. According to him, this opportunity changed his life forever.

Brad worked tirelessly with your team so his new leg could function like his real leg. Thanks to your innovative work in bionics, Brad can do almost everything he used to do. For this reason, he now views his life in a different light. In fact, he has decided to go into medicine so that he can help others as you have helped him.

Of course, I cannot thank you or praise you enough. We have our son back.

All the best to you and good luck in your research.

Donna Patrick





Let's Practice!

Do you know the difference between possibility and certainty?

Instructions: Read the sentences. Write Possibility or Certainty in the gap.

1. The prosthesis could be controlled with his mind. _____
2. Brad must be grateful after Dr. Richardson's aid. _____
3. Resignation can't be the way out. _____
4. Brad's new leg could function like his real leg. _____
5. They said he could be fitted with a robotic prosthesis. _____



Let's Practice!

Can you find the definitions?

Instructions: Match the definitions from Column A to the words in Column B.

COLUMN A

1. An arm, or a leg
2. An artificial body part
3. The study and practice of treating illnesses and injuries
4. To dominate or demand

COLUMN B

- a. To control
- b. Robothic prosthesis
- c. Medicine
- d. Limb





Extension Activity

Write a thank you letter.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- A professional person has done something to help you or someone in your family.
- Write a letter thanking the person for their service.
- Explain what they did and how it affected the person they helped (use the passive).
- Read your letter to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write a letter to thank a professional.

☐ ☐

I use discourse markers to explain what was done.

☐ ☐

I use the passive and the modal passive to describe how the person was affected.

☐ ☐

I share my letter to a professional with a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **deepest** (adjective): most heartfelt
e.g. I am writing to express my deepest gratitude for what you have done for our son, Brad.
- **gratitude** (noun): the quality or feeling of being grateful or thankful
e.g. We would like to express our gratitude to you, Dr. Richardson.
- **horrific** (adjective): used for emphasizing how big and shocking something is
e.g. Brad lost his leg in that horrific car accident last year.
- **irrevocable** (adjective): unable to be repealed or annulled
e.g. Of course, we worried that this would be irrevocable.
- **to fit** (verb): to be adapted to or suitable for (a purpose, object, occasion, etc.)
e.g. They said he could be fitted with a robotic prosthesis.
- **to control** (verb): to dominate or command
e.g. The prosthesis could be controlled with his mind.





Learning Points

Organizing Points in an Argument

Discourse markers show how ideas are connected. They usually come at the beginning of a sentence.

Discourse markers can show a **connection** to what the speaker is saying and what was just said. They can also show what the speaker's **opinion** is about what is being said.

Some discourse markers include:

Discourse Marker	Meaning
when	at the time
after all	emphasizing
then	after that
so	because of this
of course	as everybody knows, as is obvious
in fact	I want to emphasize
according to him	in his words
for this reason	introducing a cause
so that	giving a purpose

Examples:

- *When Brad lost his leg in that horrific car accident last year, he was devastated.*
- *In fact, he became very depressed and withdrawn.*
- *Of course, we worried that this would be irrevocable.*
- *After all, Brad had always been athletic and loved sports.*
- *So, he was certain that his life, as he knew it, would be over.*
- *Then, your office contacted him and gave him hope.*
- *According to him, this opportunity changed his life forever.*
- *For this reason, he now views his life in a different light.*
- *In fact, he has decided to go into medicine so that he can help others as you have helped him.*
- *Of course, I cannot thank or praise you enough.*





Learning Points

Modals for Possibility and Certainty

You can use modals to talk about degrees of certainty.

You use them to describe what is definite, probable, possible, or impossible from the speaker's point of view.

You can use must, may, might, and could to describe degrees of certainty.

Must = it's very likely

Must not/Could not/Can't = it's not possible

May/Might/Can/Could = it's possible

May not/Might not = it's possible this is not true

You use modal verbs to add meaning to other verbs. They come before the dictionary form (infinitive without *to*) of the main verb. Modal verbs can add meaning connected with certainty or obligation.

You can use modal verbs in the passive voice.

You use the passive voice when you want to focus on the "receiver" of the action, rather than the "doer" of the action.

Modal	Form
They can use this information.	active modal
They can be used to solve engineering problems.	passive modal

Examples:

- *Brad worked tirelessly with your team so his new leg could function like his real leg.*
- *He has decided to go into medicine so that he can help others as you have helped him.*
- *We worried that this would be irrevocable.*
- *He was certain that his life, as he knew it, would be over.*
- *They said he could be fitted with a robotic prosthesis.*
- *The prosthesis could be controlled with his mind.*

